



ACEnet/Sun Research Collaborations Program

Funding

As part of ACEnet's partnership with Sun Microsystems, a funding opportunity has been created to undertake projects that may match up the resources of Sun Microsystems researchers with the talent and creativity of ACEnet's user community, to the mutual benefit of both ACEnet and Sun Microsystems

The total available funding is up to \$500,000, awarded over an anticipated 3 rounds:

Round 1

February 19, 2010	Call for research proposals
March 29, 2010	Proposals due
June 25, 2010	Awards target

Round 2

	(If funding remains)
September, 2010	Call for research proposals
October, 2010	Proposals due
January, 2011	Awards target

Round 3

	(If funding remains)
February, 2011	Call for research proposals
March, 2011	Proposals due
June, 2011	Awards target

Individual awards are targeted in the \$30,000 to \$50,000 range, although there is no fixed ceiling or floor except the total funding cap of \$500,000. Funding will be based on project merit, value to ACEnet and Sun, as well as the value provided given the anticipated investments required.

Program Mandate

To reduce barriers to the efficient, effective, and widespread use of the ACEnet Research Computing Platform through the creation of innovative open source grid, middleware, or web/

portal technologies in a format that can be shared with other like institutions, and which meet Sun Microsystems research objectives.

Application

ACEnet Project Leaders are invited to submit (1) a pdf of their CV, and (2) a brief (no longer than 2 page) project synopsis (as a pdf) which

1. outlines the work to be undertaken
2. makes clear how the project fulfills the program mandate
3. provides initial budget estimates of resources required. Resources may include:
 - a. cost of postdocs, graduate students, research assistants
 - b. funding from all sources
 - c. new (ACEnet compatible) hardware or software
 - d. estimated ACEnet compute time
 - e. cost of time and expertise from the ACEnet Technical Team
 - f. time and expertise from Sun Microsystems

Submissions can be made by email to collaborations@ace-net.ca and must be received no later than 12:00 PM Atlantic, March 29, 2010.

Please submit any questions prior to proposal submission to collaborations@ace-net.ca.

Evaluation

The Research Collaborations Committee consisting of representatives from Sun, the ACEnet Executive, and the ACEnet research community will evaluate the proposals.

The evaluation considerations will be:

- Of especial interest are projects that would help researchers in non-traditional HPC areas take advantage of HPC resources.
- Projects will be judged on the degree to which they would fulfill the funding mandate.
- Successful projects will be of mutual benefit to both ACEnet and Sun Microsystems.
- Preference will be given to projects that are able to leverage matching funds.
- Only active members of the ACEnet community (Researchers, staff, executive) may apply.
- Preference will be given to projects that release results as open source.

Proposals will be shortlisted by the Research Collaborations Committee.

ACEnet and Sun Microsystems will then work with the shortlisted Project Leaders to develop the proposal (deliverables, timeline, details, synergies within both Sun Labs and the ACEnet Technical Team, etc.) culminating in a Research Agreement.

All successful applicants will be required to sign a Research Collaboration Agreement with Sun Microsystems before any funds are awarded or transferred. The form and content of this agreement will be determined by the Collaborations Committee in conjunction with best practices of Sun Labs.